

Tobias Treppmann

Director UX, Operations — design leadership for the systems operators can't walk away from
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PROFILE

Five years directing design for a data-analytics platform inside regulated banks and insurers taught me how to design for people who can't choose a simpler tool. The last year went into building a design system from zero for AI-assisted workflows — the two things a design function needs when it has to get more strategic and more technical at once.

70% / 90%

Design system as API

less coordination time, and acceptance at the launch customer, after a process was rebuilt into the platform

DTCG tokens in four tiers, built so an AI assistant reads the vocabulary it must not invent

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster, linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- A design system built for an assistant to read. Four DTCG tiers serve four platforms; an enumerated vocabulary prevents invented tokens.
- Build the recommendation, not just the deck. Prototype in real code against real and self-built APIs, so an external engineering agency ships from code that already runs.
- Agentic engineering introduced from zero, a new practice built for an ambiguous environment with no precedent to copy.
- Own UI quality across four platforms. Product managers prototype day to day, and an external engineering agency builds from my working reference.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Rebuilt the process into the platform. The booking capability cut coordination time 70%, reached 90% acceptance, then rolled out to every customer.
- Six markets, one product, under GDPR plus church data-protection law, meeting the EU Accessibility Act on customer-built websites.
- Product management and design together, one direct report. Main customer-facing contact for client projects, in a company of roughly 50.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Owned the design system and established joint governance with engineering, a standing working group of four designers and engineers.
- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines. Product Design and Product held together, July to October 2023. Senior Leadership Team throughout.
- Hired two, promoted two.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- An internal service organization, productized. Partnered with the executive team, moving case-by-case support toward a standardized service catalog through recurring workshops with department heads.
- Executive-level mandate in a 100+-person shared-services organization, including the Facilitator and Secretary constitutional roles in the company's Holacracy governance.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Design elevated from an execution function to a strategic partner. Secured executive backing for user research, using an iterative usertesting.com screening process to reach personas working inside regulated banks and insurers.
- Five years of data-dense interfaces for a regulated client base. Pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views and filter logic, plus the sample-based uncertainty problem in query-builder previews.
- Component behavior and specs across the design system library, co-built with the UI function, motion carried as custom easing curves.
- Functional head, two direct reports, peer among department heads under a VP of Design, leading the design team across Germany and NYC for five years.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade mentoring and coaching designers

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

Independent Consultant · *Oratio&Co* · 2016 – Present · Remote · Software AG, Bibel TV, Ninox Software GmbH, individual coaching

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Enterprise and regulated systems

Five years directing design inside regulated banks and insurers · data-dense interfaces · query-builder previews and the sample-based uncertainty problem · GDPR and church data-protection law across six countries

Design systems, owned and built

Design-system ownership with joint engineering governance (Ninox) · a design system co-built and specified across the library (Datameer) · a token API in four tiers, built for AI-assisted workflows (Bibel TV)

Internal-operator UX

Parish coordinators and funeral directors across 20+ cemeteries · an internal service desk turned into a standard catalog · document-based business processes for citizen developers

Leading and holding the room

Senior Leadership Team, Ninox · peer among functional heads, Datameer · executive design-thinking training and Holacracy Facilitator/Secretary, Hypoport